



Page 1 of 4 · Seven Steps Colder

Centi-Peed finds a frosted burrow beneath the roots. The entrance marker reads 3°C, but tiny firefly footprints descend seven degree-steps. “Below zero is still somewhere,” Sub-Zero says, drawing a glowing number line through the air.



Page 2 of 4 · Warm Light Ahead

At -6°C, Centi-Peed spots a warm gold shimmer farther up the tunnel. The next marker reads 2°C. Instead of fearing the minus sign, Centi counts every step through zero while Sub-Zero shelters the smallest firefly from the wind.



Page 3 of 4 · The Lantern Sequence

Four ice lanterns show -8, -4, 0, and 4. Each brighter lantern is four steps warmer than the last. Centi-Peed follows the pattern rather than guessing, and the missing fireflies answer with a cheerful flash.



Page 4 of 4 · Along Before Up

The return map marks the firefly nest at (-2, 1). A clear tunnel runs four grid steps to the right and stays at the same height. Centi-Peed leads this time, reading along the x-axis first. Every firefly reaches the moonlit roots safely.

Questions for Centi-Peed and the Below-Zero Burrow

Read the story together first. Use one question at each page, then the question at the end. Answers are below the dotted line: fold them under or cover them while reading.

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What temperature is 7 degrees below 3°C?

Choices: -10 · -4 · 4 · 10

Page 2 · Warm Light Ahead

How many degrees warmer is 2°C than -6°C?

Choices: 4 · 6 · 8 · 12

Page 3 · The Lantern Sequence

What number comes next: -8, -4, 0, 4, ...?

Choices: 6 · 8 · 10 · 12

Page 4 · Along Before Up

Starting at x = -2, what is the new x-coordinate after moving 4 steps right?

Choices: -6 · -2 · 2 · 4

Answers (fold under before reading)

Page 1: -4. Count down seven steps from 3: 2, 1, 0, -1, -2, -3, -4.

Page 2: 8. Move 6 degrees from -6 to 0, then 2 more to reach 2. The total change is 8 degrees.

Page 3: 8. The sequence increases by 4 each time. Add 4 to 4 to get 8.

Page 4: 2. Moving right adds 4 to x: -2 + 4 = 2. The y-coordinate stays unchanged.

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